

“Companies have realised that open source is one of the most important options”

Openbravo's ERP solution is being used in almost all the business sectors across the globe. Read on to know more...



Sunando Banerjee, channel business manager - Openbravo, APAC and the Middle East

Doing business with open source technology is not an alien concept anymore. A lot of tech businesses today have built their products on open source and, yes, they are making good money too. Openbravo is one such example of a company using open source software to build its solution.

Openbravo is an open source ERP system, which is extremely flexible and totally Web-based. The tool offers greater productivity, agility and a good return on investment. The state-of-the-art Openbravo ERP system also has a comprehensive retail solution, which offers multi-language and multi-currency support that makes it implementable in more than 60 countries.

The makers of the solution claim that it has more than 6000 deployments and has had more than three million downloads.

Speaking about the solution, Sunando Banerjee, channel business manager - Openbravo, APAC and the Middle East, says, “One of the strongest points of OpenBravo’s ERP solution is its simplicity. Many ERP systems fail because both partners and employers find it difficult to implement them. From its inception, the program was developed based on feedback from both customers and developers. It avoids unnecessary choices and interfaces that tend to confuse users.”

Open source: The basis of it all!

The solution has been designed using open source technology. Banerjee describes it in more detail, “The core is completely open source and has been built using Java technology as the core development platform. We use the Model Driven Development (MDD) approach that helps developers add new modules to the core. Apache Tomcat is the application server. Users have the choice of using multiple operating systems, including Windows, to access the system. For the database, we support PostgreSQL or Oracle. Openbravo’s core application platform and related open source modules are released under the Openbravo Public License, a commercial open source licence that provides users the full freedom to view and modify the source code without coercive restrictions. This licence supports our global open source community of thousands of open source enthusiasts, ERP consultants, students and business partners, who collaborate with Openbravo’s development team to continuously develop and improve our core platform and business functionality. People who invest their time and energy in Openbravo appreciate the full freedom our licence provides.”

Choosing open source technology over several proprietary variants was a conscious decision made by the company. Banerjee explains, “Within the company, we believed strongly in the open source philosophy and this was backed by a strong business plan. All of which made us choose open source as the technology for this product. Open source gives you the freedom to be flexible. We are not against proprietary solutions. But you always need to remember the value a strong community can bring to